

TN CHANNEL

Product Strategy & Business Model

User-Driven Linear TV with Smartphone Integration

Market: Tamil Nadu | Business Model: AVOD

Executive Summary

TN Channel addresses a critical market gap in Tamil Nadu: user control without subscription friction.

Traditional linear TV lacks audience control. OTT platforms demand subscriptions and broadband—excluding 60%+ of Tamil Nadu. TN Channel bridges this gap through user-driven programming via WhatsApp, running on existing cable/DTH infrastructure.

The Innovation: Users select from 4 movies daily via WhatsApp. System maps their STB. At scheduled slot time, TV automatically routes to selected movie. Linear playback (no pause/rewind).

The Business Case: 4 parallel feeds = 4x ad inventory. Hyper-targeted ads = premium rates. Zero channel-surfing = max retention during ads.

1. Problem Space & Market Opportunity

1.1 The Market Gap

- Linear TV: Fixed schedules → no control → cord-cutting
- OTT: ₹199-499/month + broadband = excludes 60%+ Tamil Nadu
- Gap: 15M+ cable/DTH subscribers want control but can't afford OTT

1.2 Target Audience

- Middle-class households (₹25K-75K monthly)
- Cable/DTH subscribers (15M+ in Tamil Nadu)
- Age 25-55 (family decision-makers)

2. Core Concept: User-Driven Linear TV

2.1 Five-Step User Journey

Step 1 - Discovery: TV shows 4 movies (Movie A, B, C, D)

Step 2 - Selection: User sends 'Movie B' via WhatsApp

Step 3 - Options: Bot shows time slots (10 AM, 1 PM, 4 PM, 8 PM)

Step 4 - Selection: User picks '4 PM'

Step 5 - Playback: At 4 PM, TV auto-routes to Movie B. Linear (3 hrs) with ads.

2.2 WhatsApp Bot Conversation Flow

User	Bot Response	User Selection	Result
Hi	Today's 4 movies: 🧑‍🧑 Movie A 🔥 Movie B 😊 Movie C 🔍 Movie D	Movie B	Movie B selected
	When to watch? 🕒 10 AM 🕒 1 PM 🕒 4 PM 🕒 8 PM	4 PM	✅ Movie B at 4 PM confirmed

3. Content Architecture: 4-Movie Daily Grid

Each day, 4 parallel feeds target distinct audiences at peak viewing times.

MOVIE A	MOVIE B	MOVIE C	MOVIE D
Kids Content	Action Thriller	Family Drama	Crime Drama
Animation, Kids, Family	Action Blockbuster	Drama, Comedy, Romance	Crime, Thriller, Mystery
10 AM, 1 PM	8 PM (Prime)	4 PM, 12 PM	8:30 PM (Late)
Kids (4-14), Parents	Youth (18-35), Families	Housewives (25-50)	Adults (25-55)

4. Business Model: 4x Ad Inventory Advantage

4.1 Revenue Math

Traditional Linear TV: 1 feed × 15 slots/day = ₹3-6L daily

TN Channel: 4 parallel feeds × 60 slots/day = ₹12-24L daily (4x)

4.2 Revenue Streams

Primary (70%): Dynamic Advertising

- Premium 30-sec slot: ₹80K-150K (vs. ₹20K-40K traditional)
- Hyper-targeted by content type + Category exclusivity

Secondary (20%): Data & Partnerships

- Regional analytics → producers, studios

- MSO/DTH revenue share: TN Channel 40%, MSO 60%

5. Technical Architecture

5.1 System Layers

User Layer: TV (Standard STB), WhatsApp Bot, Mobile App

Integration Layer: Request Parser, STB ID Mapper, MSO/DTH API, Analytics

Content Delivery: Playout Cloud (4 feeds), DVR Storage, Encoder, Ad Server

5.2 Why It Works on Dumb STBs

- ✓ No Smart TV needed. Works on standard copper cable STBs
- ✓ Zero broadband dependency. WhatsApp via cellular, routing on cable
- ✓ No software upgrades on millions of homes
- ✓ Works on 4G + copper cable hybrid

6. Go-to-Market Strategy (Chennai Launch)

Phase 1: Pilot (Months 1-3)

- Partner: 1 major MSO in Chennai (500K-1M households)
- Test: 4-movie grid, WhatsApp bot, ad integration
- Measure: Adoption, retention, ad completion, revenue/slot

Phase 2: Scale (Months 4-9)

- Expand: 3-4 additional MSOs in Chennai suburbs
- Advertiser: FMCG, e-commerce, auto brands
- Content: Deepen library, seasonal rotations

Phase 3: Regional (Months 10-18)

- Expand: Coimbatore, Madurai, Trichy (Tier-2)
- Scale: 5M+ households, 60K+ daily active users

7. KPIs & Success Metrics (Month 6 Target)

Metric	Target	Success Indicator
Daily Active Users	25K-30K	5%+ of market
Daily Viewership	90K-120K hrs	3-4 hrs/user
Ad Completion Rate	92%+	vs. 40-50% linear

Monthly Revenue	₹80L-₹1Cr	60 slots × ₹100K
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8. Competitive Position

vs. Traditional Linear TV (JioTV, Airtel Xstream)

Advantage: User-driven selection + zero surfing = exponential ad engagement

Disadvantage: Limited to 4 movies/day (vs. 100+ channels)

vs. OTT (Hotstar, ZEE5, Netflix)

Advantage: Free + existing infrastructure + social viewing + zero broadband

Disadvantage: No pause/rewind (not true on-demand)

9. Conclusion & Future

The Hybrid Model: Future TV isn't binary (linear vs. OTT). It's hybrid: user-driven discovery on linear infrastructure with advertising monetization rewarding quality engagement.

Why Tamil Nadu: 15M+ cable/DTH households, regional content preference, mature MSO ecosystem, zero adoption friction (free), language support (Tamil/English).

Key Differentiators: No subscription = viral growth. 4x ad arbitrage = venture economics. Dumb STB compatible = zero friction. Data insights = secondary revenue.

Future Roadmap:

- Phase 4: National expansion (Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Mumbai)
- Phase 5: International (Tamil diaspora markets)
- Phase 6: Premium tier (pause/rewind, multiple feeds, ad-free)